

Unvoiced (/θ/) and Voiced (/ð/) 'th' Sounds

The only difference between these is **θ** is spoken with no voice (so if you touch your throat, you won't feel anything) and **ð** has a voice (so your throat will vibrate). Try saying "think" and then "this" to feel the difference.

To make these sound, rest the end of your tongue under your top front teeth and gently force air between them.

Below are some 'minimal pairs' (words with only one sound different) – try saying the two words together so you can hear and feel the difference!

/θ/ and /s/

sink / think

sought / thought

sick / thick

sing / thing

seem / theme

faceless / faithless

some / thumb

pass / path

tense / tenth

mouse / mouth

/ð/ and /d/

day / they

den / then

doe / though

lied / lithe

sudden / southern

breed / breathe

load / loathe

udder / other

wordy / worthy

dough / though